

Compare the observable properties of soils, rocks and minerals and investigate why they are important Earth resources

Learning intention

- compare the observable properties of soils, rocks and minerals and investigate why they are important Earth resources.

Teach and model

- investigating which rocks or minerals are quarried or mined locally or regionally and how those resources are used.
- examining different soils from local areas and using magnifying glasses to observe their components, such as pebbles.
- examining information on plant tags and exploring the vocabulary used to describe soils and different plant soil requirements.

Check understanding

- Explain the main idea and give one accurate example.
- Show the idea in a second way: with words, a model, a diagram or symbols.
- Apply the idea to a short unfamiliar situation and justify the result.

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Teaching cautions

- Ask the student to explain their choice, not only state an answer.
- Check that key vocabulary is understood in a new example.
- Mix representations so the skill is transferred rather than copied.

Quick lesson sequence

- Connect to prior knowledge and introduce the key vocabulary.
- Model one clear example, then solve a second example together.
- Finish with an independent check and a short student explanation.